OSHA Hot Work Fire Watch Checklist (29 CFR 1926.352)

Use before and after each hot work job on site.

OSHA 29 CFR 1926.352

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A before hot work starts; recheck section B after the work ends.
2. If any item is a Defect, don't start or continue the work until it is corrected, and record what was done.
3. Manufacturer's instructions and site rules may add checks to this list.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1926.352: Fire prevention (Part 1926 Subpart J, Welding and Cutting) 49 CFR part 192: Minimum Federal Safety Standards for Gas Pipelines (referenced by 1926.352(i)) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1926-352-fire-prevention

SECTION A | Work location and surrounding fire hazards

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Object moved to safe location Ref. 1926.352(a)	Where moving it was practical, the object being worked on sits in a designated safe location.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Movable fire hazards cleared Ref. 1926.352(a)	Where the object stays put, every movable fire hazard nearby has been taken to a safe place or protected.	☐	☐	☐	
3	Heat, sparks and slag confined Ref. 1926.352(b)	Where the object and some hazards can't be moved, positive means are in place that confine heat, sparks and slag and protect the immovable hazards.	☐	☐	☐	
4	No flammable paints, compounds or heavy dust Ref. 1926.352(c)	No flammable paint being applied, no other flammable compounds and no heavy dust concentrations creating a hazard at the work point.	☐	☐	☐	
5	Opposite side of walls, floors and ceilings Ref. 1926.352(f)	For work on a wall, floor or ceiling, the adjacent side has the same precautions as the working side.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Fire extinguishing equipment and fire watch

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
6	Extinguishing equipment at hand Ref. 1926.352(d)	Suitable fire extinguishing equipment is in the work area itself and immediately available.	☐	☐	☐	
7	Equipment ready for instant use Ref. 1926.352(d)	Extinguishing equipment is in a state of readiness for instant use when checked.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Fire watch assigned when needed Ref. 1926.352(e)	Where normal precautions aren't sufficient, extra personnel are assigned to guard against fire for the whole time the work is performed.	☐	☐	☐	
9	Fire watch stays after the work Ref. 1926.352(e)	Fire guard remains after completion until there is no possibility of fire.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION B | Fire extinguishing equipment and fire watch

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
10	Fire watch instructed Ref. 1926.352(e)	Fire guard can name the specific anticipated fire hazards and explain how to use the firefighting equipment provided.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Torches and hoses in enclosed spaces

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Gas shut off outside the space Ref. 1926.352(g)	Torch gas supply is positively shut off at a point outside the enclosed space whenever the torch is not in use or left unattended for a substantial period, such as lunch.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Torch and hose out overnight and at shift change Ref. 1926.352(g)	No torch or hose left inside the confined space overnight or at the change of shifts.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Disconnected hoses removed Ref. 1926.352(g)	Open-end fuel gas and oxygen hoses are taken out of the enclosed space as soon as they are disconnected from the torch or other gas-consuming device.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION D | Drums, containers and hollow structures

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
14	Flammable-liquid containers closed Ref. 1926.352(h)	Drums, pails and other containers that hold or held flammable liquids are closed unless contents are being removed or transferred.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Empty containers removed Ref. 1926.352(h)	Empty containers are in a safe area apart from hot work and open flames.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Vessels filled or cleaned, ventilated and tested Ref. 1926.352(i)	Before hot work, any drum, container or hollow structure that held toxic or flammable substances is either filled with water or thoroughly cleaned, ventilated and tested.	☐	☐	☐	
17	Natural gas pipeline work Ref. 1926.352(i)	For steel pipelines containing natural gas, the work follows the pertinent portions of 49 CFR part 192.	☐	☐	☐	
18	Vent or opening provided Ref. 1926.352(j)	A vent or opening is in place on the drum, container or hollow structure before heat is applied, to release built-up pressure.	☐	☐	☐	

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DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE?	☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE		DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW		DATE / TIME